Warehouse backlog and staff reassignment

Could a small team help delivery while keeping enough cover in recycling?

The starting point

Personal observations of warehouse disruption during 2025 prompted me to explore how backlog and staff availability could be reviewed together.

What I built

An Excel simulation tracking incoming and completed orders, closing backlog, paid-hour productivity and department load. Staff transfers include training, mentor time and lower efficiency in an unfamiliar role.

42
operating days

3
departments

18
training hours

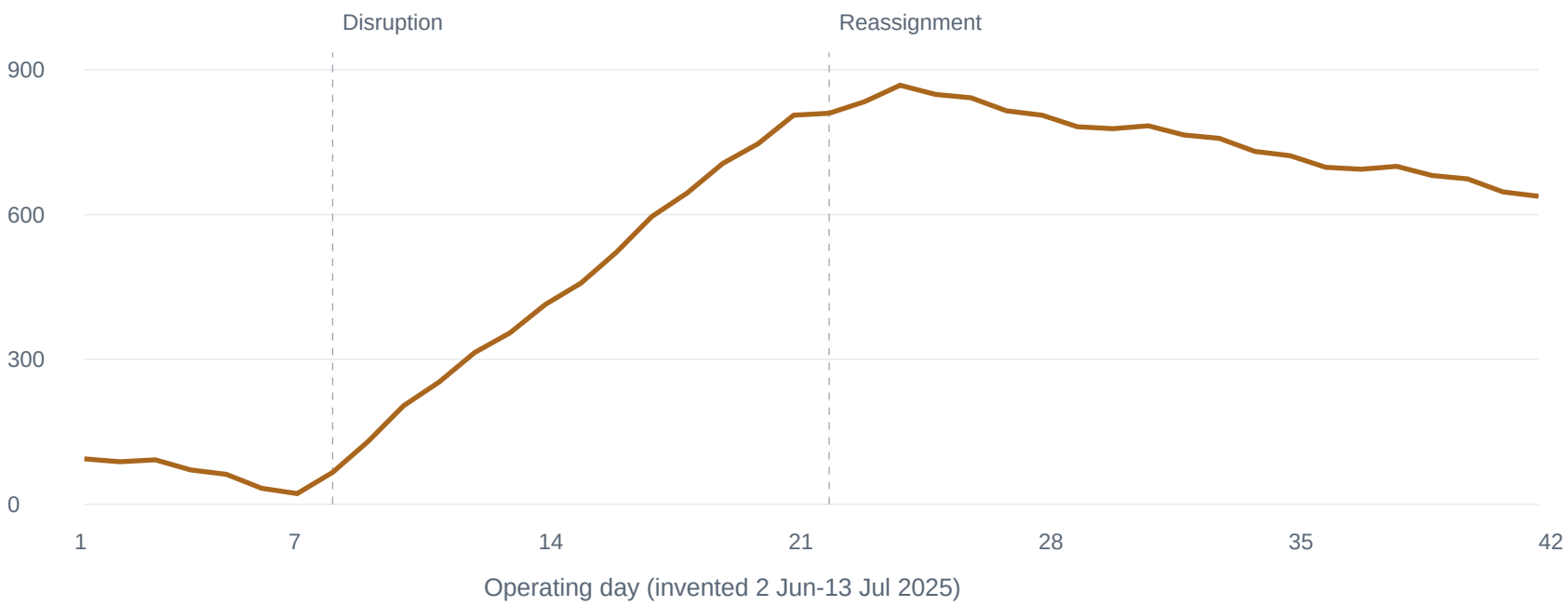
Inspired by experience. Built with fictional data.
All dates, figures, staffing and outcomes are synthetic. No company data, internal records or documents were used. This independent simulation is not a reconstruction of an employer's operations or an employer-endorsed project.

WHAT THE SYNTHETIC SCENARIO SHOWS

Partial recovery, with backlog remaining

Backlog peaks at **868 orders** and ends at **638**: a **26.5% decline from the peak**. It is not fully cleared. Delivery output per paid hour remains below baseline.

Daily closing backlog (orders)



Recycling load moves from **44.4%** during disruption to **74.0%** during reassignment. Delivery output per paid hour is **2.45** at baseline, **1.88** during disruption and **1.95** during reassignment.

Native productivity and demand also change by assumption. The decline cannot be attributed to staff reassignment alone, and it does not establish real company improvements or savings.

What I would review in practice

Spare paid hours are not the same as usable capacity. I would review training needs, delivery backlog and the cover left in recycling together before discussing a transfer.